

JOINTRIL-Glucosamine Sulphate

Description : Red op./Cream op. capsules

Content : Each capsule contains :
Crystalline Glucosamine Sulphate.....314.0mg
(equivalent to Glucosamine Sulphate 250mg)

Indication : As adjuvant therapy for osteoarthritis

Pharmacology:

Glucosamine is an aminomonosaccharide, particularly used in the management of all forms of degenerative osteoarticular diseases e.g. arthrosis and osteoarthritis, both subacute and chronic, with disappearance or reduction of articular pains, improvement of articular functions and inhibition or regression of the degeneration process. Glucosamine possesses arthrotrophic metabolic activity by stimulating the anabolic metabolism of osteocartilaginous tissues, through the stimulation of the biosynthesis of the mucopolysaccharides (which are essential components of the cartilage substances) and of the bone mesenchymal tissues.

Lubricant activities are through improvement of synovial fluid viscosity by increasing synovial fluid production. After oral administration, only 26% is absorbed, with onset of action about 2-3 weeks for osteoarthritis. Bioavailability is low due to its first pass hepatic metabolism. Following oral administration, glucosamine is extensively metabolised in the liver. It is rapidly desulfated and metabolised into smaller molecules, and ultimately to carbon dioxide, water and urea. Glucosamine is not protein-bound, but rather incorporates into the plasma proteins (primarily globulin). Rapid diffusion into most tissues also occurs, including articular tissues. Urinary excretion accounts for 10 % of an oral dose, about 11% is eliminated via the faeces, presumably as an unabsorbed drug. The elimination half-life of glucosamine which is incorporated into the plasma proteins is about 68 hours after oral doses. Part of a dose of glucosamine sulfate is eliminated as carbon dioxide via expired air in the lungs.

Adverse effects:

Cardiovascular: Peripheral oedema, tachycardia were reported in a few patients following larger clinical trials investigating oral administration in osteoarthritis. Causal relationship has not been established.

Central nervous system: Drowsiness, headache, insomnia have been observed rarely during therapy (less than 1%).

Gastrointestinal: Nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea, dyspepsia or epigastric pain, constipation, heartburn and anorexia have been described rarely during oral therapy of osteoarthritis.

Skin: Skin reactions such as erythema and pruritis have been reported with therapeutic administration of glucosamine.

12-04-17

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Precaution: Glucosamine sulphate is a causal therapy and the therapeutic effect is only seen after 1 week. Therefore, it is advisable to include an anti-inflammatory drug (in case of severe pain) during the first days of treatment with glucosamine.

Contraindication: It is contraindicated in patients who are hypersensitive to glucosamine.

Dosage and Administration:

Light to moderate symptoms - 2 capsules twice daily before meals for at least 6 weeks.

Severe symptoms - 2 capsules three times daily before meals.

Capsules should be taken 15 minutes before each meal. Treatment should be repeated every other 6 months or less according to medical prescription.

Storage: Store in a dry place at temperature below 30°C. Protect from light. Keep out of reach of children.

Packaging: Blister-packed - 5 strips x 10's

Shelf life: 3 years.

Contract Manufactured for Medipharma Industries Sdn Bhd
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Reg No: MAL20014230XC